Checkout outage after replica set election (inc-4821)

INC-4821, https://status.example.com/incidents/4821
Times in America/New_York. Exported 2026-09-13 23:03 EDT by coroner v0.0.0-20260914030105-ae353324c03d.

On the whole timeline

Comment by julian
Started from the CheckoutLatencyHigh page.

2026-09-10 (EDT)

13:40:02	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh #db #election
13:40:15	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
13:40:18	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
13:40:31	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
~13:40:33		Incident acknowledged by sam
13:40:46	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
13:40:54	app	Retry storm: 4873 retries/s
13:40:56	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
13:40:59	app	Retry storm: 7652 retries/s
13:41:00	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
13:41:20	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout #db #election
13:41:28	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
~13:41:29	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
~13:51:30		sam: rolling back deploy 812?
~13:51:35		Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
~13:51:37		Deploy 812 finished
13:51:39–13:53:35	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
13:51:40	app	Retry storm: 7553 retries/s
~13:51:43		Retry storm: 1877 retries/s
13:51:51	mongod	Replica set election started
13:51:59	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout #customer

13:52:04	mongod	Oplog window below 1h #db #election
13:52:24	mongod	Replica set election started
13:52:32	app	checkout p99 6215 ms
13:52:45	mongod	COLLSCAN on orders.status
13:52:48	mongod	COLLSCAN on orders.status #customer
13:53	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?
13:53:01	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
13:53:04	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (3472 waiting)
13:53:17	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
13:53:20	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
13:53:25	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
13:53:38–14:07:33	k8s	Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d
13:53:40–13:58:49	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (2835 waiting)
~13:53:53	k8s	HPA scaled checkout to 2917 replicas
13:53:56	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
13:54:00	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
13:54:02–14:00:03	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
14:14:04	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
14:14:09	mongod	Replica set election started
~14:14:10	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?
14:14:15	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
14:14:16	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:14:29	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
14:14:31	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
14:14:51	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
14:14:59	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
14:15	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
14:15	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
14:15:12	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
14:15:17–14:28:54	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
14:15:37	mongod	Slow query on checkout.orders: 5343 ms
14:15:40	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished

14:15:48	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started #db #election
14:16:04	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
14:16:17	mongod	Replica set election started
14:16:22–14:31:02	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:16:42	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?
14:16:43	mongod	Replica set election started
14:16:45–14:23:52	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T18:16:45Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
14:17	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?
14:17	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
14:17:05	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
14:17:18	mongod	Slow query on checkout.orders: 7045 ms
14:17:26	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (6518 waiting)
14:17:28	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
14:17:36	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?
14:17:42	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
14:17:55	mongod	COLLSCAN on orders.status #db #election
14:18:08	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
14:18:16	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started #db #election
14:18:18	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
14:46	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:46	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
14:46:23	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:46:24	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
14:46:34	app	Retry storm: 1294 retries/s
14:46:36	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
14:46:56–14:57:19	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
14:47:00	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled) #db #election

14:47:02	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
14:47:04	k8s	Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T18:47:04Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
14:47:07	app	checkout p99 3636 ms
14:47:12	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
14:47:14	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout #customer
14:47:22	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled) #customer
14:47:24	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:47:29	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (4782 waiting)
14:47:32	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:47:37	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
14:47:57	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
14:47:59	app	checkout p99 3529 ms
14:48:01	k8s	HPA scaled checkout to 2582 replicas
14:48:03	mongod	Replica set election started
14:48:06	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
14:48:26	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
14:48:28	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
14:48:48	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs #db #election
14:48:50	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
14:49:03	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
~14:49:05	k8s	Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d
14:49:08	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout #db #election Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T18:49:08Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
14:49:28	mongod	Slow query on checkout.orders: 2135 ms
15:--	grafana	Traffic started climbing
15:01:29	app	checkout p99 1824 ms

~15:01:49	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
15:01:51	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
15:01:53	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
15:01:56	k8s	Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d
15:02:09	k8s	HPA scaled checkout to 3801 replicas
15:02:22	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
15:02:35	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
~15:02:37		Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
15:02:39	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
15:02:40	k8s	Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d
15:02:43	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
15:02:51–15:08:41	app	Retry storm: 1077 retries/s
~15:25:53	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
15:25:54	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
15:25:57	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
15:26:02	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout #customer
15:26:05	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
15:26:07	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
15:26:27	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
15:26:47	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
15:26:52	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started #db #election
15:26:53	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh #customer
15:27:01	app	checkout p99 8887 ms
15:27:02	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
15:27:15–15:39:00	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
15:27:18	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
15:27:26	app	Retry storm: 6232 retries/s
15:27:39	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call

15:27:40	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T19:27:40Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
15:27:42	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
15:28:02	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
15:28:03	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
15:28:11	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
15:28:12	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (4026 waiting)
15:28:13	mongod	Replica set election started
15:28:16	app	Retry storm: 1253 retries/s
15:28:36	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
15:28:56	app	checkout p99 4983 ms
15:28:57	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
15:29:00–15:37:53	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
15:29:02	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
15:29:22	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
15:29:25	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started #db #election
15:29:45	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started #customer
~15:29:47		Deploy 812 finished
15:29:49–15:34:47	mongod	COLLSCAN on orders.status
15:29:50	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
16:09:58	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
16:10:01	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
16:10:02	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
16:10:04	app	Retry storm: 1562 retries/s
16:10:07	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T20:10:07Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
16:10:15	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
16:10:17	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?

16:10:18	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
16:10:31	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
16:10:36	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 272%
16:10:37	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
16:10:45	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
16:10:48	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
16:10:49	grafana	Error rate at 7581%
16:10:57	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
16:11:10	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
~16:11:30		Retry storm: 211 retries/s
16:11:31	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
16:11:33	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
16:11:38	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
16:11:41	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
16:11:43	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 6188%
16:11:44	grafana	Error rate at 6165% #customer
16:11:49	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 4517%
16:12:02	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 3189%
16:12:22	grafana	Error rate at 2929%
16:36:23	grafana	Error rate at 8958% Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T20:36:23Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
16:36:25	mongod	Slow query on checkout.orders: 2403 ms
16:36:28	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
16:36:41	mongod	Replica set election started
16:36:49	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (2462 waiting)
16:36:54	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
~16:37:07		Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d
16:37:08–16:38:53	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
16:37:21–16:41:39	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
16:37:22	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 7642%

16:37:30	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started #db #election
16:37:43	k8s	Readiness probe failed on checkout-5b2d
~16:37:48		Connection pool exhausted (8008 waiting)
16:38:08	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 2365%
16:38:10	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
16:38:30	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
16:38:35	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
16:38:43	k8s	HPA scaled checkout to 643 replicas
16:38:48	mongod	Replica set election started
17:10:08	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
17:10:28	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1 #db #election
17:10:41	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
17:11:01	grafana	Error rate at 4726%
17:11:02	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
17:11:07–17:19:42	app	Retry storm: 4606 retries/s
17:11:08	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
17:11:13	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
17:11:16	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
17:11:36	mongod	Slow query on checkout.orders: 4964 ms
17:11:38	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
17:11:41	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
17:11:54	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
17:11:55	grafana	Error rate at 946% Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:11:55Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
17:12	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:12Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
~17:12:16		Deploy 812 finished
17:12:19–17:22:14	grafana	Error rate at 5743%

17:12:21	grafana	Error rate at 8252%
17:12:22	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 finished
~17:12:24		HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
17:12:44	app	Circuit breaker opened for orders-db
17:12:57	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
17:13:00	mongod	COLLSCAN on orders.status
17:13:13	mongod	Slow query on checkout.orders: 4978 ms
17:13:26	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
17:13:39	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
17:13:41	mongod	COLLSCAN on orders.status Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:13:41Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
17:13:54	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 7940%
17:13:55	grafana	Error rate at 5990%
17:13:57	mongod	Connection pool exhausted (248 waiting)
17:14:02	deploy-bot	Rollback of deploy 812 started
17:14:05	deploy-bot	Deploy 812 started
17:14:06	grafana	Error rate at 5819%
17:14:14	app	checkout p99 7408 ms
17:14:22	mongod	Primary stepped down: replSetStepDown
17:14:27	grafana	Disk IOPS saturation on db-1
17:45	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
17:45:29	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
17:45:30–17:59:11	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812? Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:45:30Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
17:45:34	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:45:34Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
17:45:47	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?

17:45:49	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
~17:45:57		Incident acknowledged by sam
17:46:00	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh #db #election Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:46:00Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
17:46:20	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
17:46:40	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
17:46:53	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh #db #election
17:46:56	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
17:47	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
~17:47:04	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
17:47:07	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
~17:47:23		Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
17:47:24	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
17:47:27	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
~17:47:32	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
17:47:45	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
17:48	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
17:48:05	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
17:48:06	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
17:48:08	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
~17:48:09	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
17:48:12	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
17:48:32	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
17:48:52	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
17:49	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
17:49:05	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
17:49:10	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users

17:49:15–17:51:51	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T21:49:15Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
17:49:17	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs #db #election
17:49:25	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
~17:49:31		Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
18:04:39	slack	sam: rolling back deploy 812?
18:04:52	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
18:04:54	k8s	HPA scaled checkout to 6221 replicas
18:04:57	app	Retry storm: 1809 retries/s
18:05:17	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout Evidence by julian `{"t":{"$date":"2026-09-10T22:05:17Z"},"msg":"Slow query","attr":{"ns":"checkout.orders"}}`
18:05:19	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled) #customer
18:05:32	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
18:05:35	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
18:05:48	app	Retry storm: 1973 retries/s
18:05:53–18:10:31	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
18:05:56	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
~18:05:58	app	checkout p99 1659 ms
18:06:11	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
18:06:24	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
18:06:27	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
18:06:47	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
18:06:55	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments
~18:07:15	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
18:07:18	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
18:07:38	mongod	Oplog window below 1h
18:07:39	app	HTTP 503 from /api/checkout
18:07:44	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs

18:07:52	mongod	Replica set election started
18:08:05	pagerduty	Alert triggered: CheckoutLatencyHigh
18:08:25	slack	julian: looking at mongod logs
18:08:38	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call #db #election
~18:08:43		HPA scaled checkout to 5544 replicas
~18:08:46	k8s	Pod checkout-7f9c restarted (OOMKilled)
18:45	pagerduty	Incident acknowledged by sam
18:45:51	slack	ops: customers reporting failed payments #db #election
18:45:54	pagerduty	Escalated to database on-call
18:46:16	slack	maria: checkout is timing out for EU users
18:46:19	grafana	CPU on db-2 at 2515%